

Toh 651 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text dedicated to the bodhisattva Aval

Toh 651 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 651 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text dedicated to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, known in Sanskrit as Avalokiteśvara and in Tibetan as Phags pa Chenrezig, concerning the power of a specific mantra to bestow the gift of perfect memory and retention of teachings heard. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a concise ritual instruction in which reciting the mantra one hundred and eight times over black sesame seeds and consuming them is said to make the practitioner an unfailing holder of all that has been heard. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian master Vidyākarasiṃha together with the great translator Bandé Devacandra, under the patronage of a Nāga King. As is typical of texts of this class, it combines a short dhāraṇī formula with practical instructions for its application, situating it within the broader Kangyur corpus of esoteric and protective literature associated with Avalokiteśvara.

Translated by the Indian master Vidyākarasiṃha and the great translator Bandé Devacandra, under the patronage of the Nāga King.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of All Who See.

Thus it is: smṛti mati mati, teja vidyā, huru me huru huru me kṛṣṇa haru me svāhā.

If one recites this mantra one hundred and eight times over pure black sesame seeds and eats them, one will without fail become a holder of what has been heard. Having heard

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens mid-colophon: the phrase rendered "under the patronage of the Nāga King" translates a phrase that more literally means "revised by the Nāga King" or "under the authority of the Nāga King," likely referring to a royal patron with a nāga-related title or epithet rather than a literal nāga being. The exact identity is uncertain and may refer to a Tibetan royal official with such an honorific.

The mantra is preserved in approximate Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit syllables and is rendered here in reconstructed Sanskrit phonetic form as is standard practice. The final word of the translation is cut off in the source, as the passage ends abruptly mid-sentence with "Having heard."

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.